Name:_____ Date: 2024/09/11

Claims, Counterclaims, and Rebuttals Practice Worksheet

Directions: Find the claim, counterclaim, and rebuttals/support below. Label each one in the space provided.

Paragraph A Answers: (1 Claim, 1 Counterclaim, 2 Rebuttals)

The evolution of television in the twentieth century drastically changed how American families interact with each other together. _____ 1. In fact, the invention of television has led to the decrease in family time and ultimately families bonding. Prior to invention of the television; families would play games together, participate in sports, and go outdoors. _____ 2. Some may say that television can benefit young children who watch educational shows. _____ 3. However, studies have shown that children who spend more time in front of the tv lack critical communication skills, and that is a critical part of child development. _____ 4. *Parents.org* reports that two-thirds of children in the US have a television in their bedroom, and they spend more time watching television than doing any other activity except sleeping. In that case, families are allowing the tv to take on a dominant present in their lives – more dominant than face-to-face bonding.

Paragraph B Answers: (1 Claim, 2 Counterclaims, 4 Rebuttals)

The video games phenomenon is somewhat new in the twentieth century. Although they can often be entertaining, the content has become more graphic and realistic as computing technology has become much more advanced. Thus, the question of the violence in video games has caused some senators to propose a bill to regulate age restrictions on purchasing video games, _____ 1. but that ruling would be a mistake. _____ 2. Parents and experts feel that some games are just too violent and they demand the government to regulate the sales of these games. The article "Don't Shoot: Why Video Games Really Are Linked to Violence" by Amanda Schaffer from Slate.com stated, "In playing the games, kids are likely to become desensitized to gory images, which could make them less disturbing and shocking in real life"(Schaffer). _____ 3. Though this presents evidence that violent games do reduce a reaction to seeing violence, _____ 4. this data can be considered a misrepresentation of statistics because the test conducted by Schaffer's team was conducted in a controlled environment, without considering other aspects that might result in the said change in behavior. Additionally, although violent video games might expose children to violent behavior, _____ 5. the amount of violence is not as great as the ones in movies and television. _____6. The news is filled with stories of war and murder, and nearly every movie contains some forms of violence. _____ 7. In fact, as mentioned by Dr. Kipling D. Williams Ph. D, one of the social psychological science faculties in Purdue University, children's violent tendencies can be diverted towards violent video games rather than actually doing it in the real life (Williams). Violent video games do not cause an increase in aggression in adolescents and the forceful plan by the government is caused by an exaggeration of the effects of violent video games and this plan are indeed pointless.